

Internship 1 Self-Care

 **Your Top 3 Survival Kit Items:** What practices or strategies help you maintain your well-being during internship? I have realized I need to be active and either take a small run or walk during my free time. Not moving allows me to overthink my clients life and what they are up to even when I am not providing services. Going on walks while listening to music helps me relax and let go of any triggers that have happened throughout the week. I also prioritize spending time with my family, friends, and getting enough sleep. This has been extremely important to me during my practicum and internship time. Being surrounded by people that care about my mental health has been a blessing.

 **Your Biggest Energy Drain:** What aspect of internship has been most challenging for your self-care, and how have you managed it? Managing a caseload of 8 clients because I am not used to this, especially completing 300 hrs in 2 months. Internship is a learning experience that I am learning how to manage.

 **A Self-Care Myth:** What's a common misconception about self-care that you've discovered isn't true? A myth I have discovered is not true is that it takes a lot of time and there is no time. Allowing yourself 5-10 minutes of time just to yourself is doable.

 **One New Strategy:** Is there a self-care practice you've recently adopted—or want to try—that you think could benefit counselors-in-training? I would love to try learning how to play an instrument. Music is very healing but being able to play your own music - I feel would be very rewarding.

 **Words of Wisdom:** Share one piece of advice you would give a future counseling intern about balancing client care and self-care : Self-care does not have to be expensive and/or time consuming. Enjoy a few minutes or hours to yourself without feeling guilty for not studying. It is okay to take a mental break.

Reflection - For my self care, I was able to get out of town and visit friends I made in undergrad at UTSA. I drove to Dallas at night with music and that felt so relaxing. When I got there, I was able to forget I was balancing my life working, doing an internship at the Boys and Girls Club, and attending grad school. That weekend was extremely relaxing since I got to spend time with friends, catch up, watch movies while we ate ice cream out of the tub. I was reminiscing about how peaceful life was and savoring the moment. This activity is something I do not get to do as often because I struggle finding the time on weekends since I dedicate my free time to homework. As I reflect, taking the time off to go out, explore the city, and enjoy cozy time will impact my career because I am more aware that self-care is essential in this profession. Finding time to do something we enjoy without thinking of our caseload for a moment will take us a long way in the counseling career.